

PROPOSAL · MIDDLESEX UNIVERSITY · SEPTEMBER 2026

They booked. Now make sure they **turn up.**

A content system for the five weeks between an open day booking and the open day itself — the one stretch of the recruitment funnel that nobody currently owns.

The brief

Lift show-up rate across the open day programme.

What we are not touching

Your media buying. Your performance team already fills the top.

Where we work

Booking confirmation to campus door, then the week after.

Not in here

Costs. This is a scope document; fees follow once it is agreed.

HOW TO READ THIS

Six sections. Start at section five if you only want the plan.

Four sections of evidence come before a single recommendation, because the plan only makes sense as a consequence of them. Everything in sections one and two was gathered from outside the organisation, on 11 and 12 September 2026.

One • Where you stand today

What your own channels, ads and pages say before we assert anything.

Two • What happens after the booking

The five-week window, and what a booked person actually receives in it.

Three • Who we have to move

Three people are in this decision. Only one of them filled in the form.

Four • What Middlesex can own

The one open day claim the competitive set has left unclaimed.

Five • How the plan works

The five-week system, the search and AI workstream, and how we judge it.

Six • To start

Five things we need from you, each with the reason we want it.

Everything here comes from public sources, on a dated snapshot. Some of it will have moved by the time you read this, and we have not seen your booking data or your reminder emails at all.

ONE

Where Middlesex stands today

Three things are true at once: you have more attention than you are using, the open day itself is well built, and the bridge between them is one sentence long.

ONE · REACH

You are not short of attention. You are short of somewhere to send it.

Views on the nineteen videos visible on your TikTok profile grid, against the follower count on the same profile.

2.51m

Views on 19 videos

Four of them carry 96% of it — 1.2m, 876.1K, 168.2K and 168K.

4,569

TikTok followers

About 549 views for every follower you hold.

3,305

Median video

The typical post, once the hits are set aside.

185

Views on "Open Day: What to Expect"

On YouTube, where your last 12 uploads averaged 694.

The content is good, and it is working

These are real captions from the grid. They are fluent, native and clearly made by people who understand the platform:

- "Slay king ✨ #MiddlesexUni #CampusTour #GenZ #UniTok"
- "Rate the gym outfit 💪 The student off peak pass is only £60 a year?"
- "Brand new term loading 📖⌚ "

And none of it has a job

A video reaching 1.2 million people is the single largest audience Middlesex assembles all year. Nothing in that moment asks anyone to book an open day, and nothing tells a person who already booked one what their day will look like. The reach is real; it simply arrives and leaves.

Middlesex is not short of attention. It is short of a path from attention to a seat that actually gets filled.

ONE · THE PRODUCT

The open day itself is already well designed.

This is what your own programme page publishes for Sunday 18 October. We are including it because the rest of this proposal depends on it being true.

A real agenda, with rooms

- Welcome talks, 10am and 12pm, CG77 and CG76
- UCAS and personal statements, 12.30pm
- Accommodation 1pm · Student finance 1.30pm
- Library tours at 12, 12.30, 1 and 1.30

Subject sessions that do something

"A course talk at our Open Day is much more — each subject session has an interactive, experiential element." Tasters, one-to-one time with lecturers, faculty zones, student-led tours of the halls.

Practical detail already written

Registration points named. Doors from 9.30am. On-site parking during open events. Ten minutes from the Northern Line and Thameslink, adjacent to the North Circular and the A41.

Said plainly: nobody is failing to turn up because the day is weak or because the information does not exist. Somebody has done careful work here. The problem is when, and whether, a booked person ever meets it.

The day is not the problem. Almost nobody who reads your programme page decides not to come.

ONE · THE FINDING

Between the booking and the day, there is one sentence.

This is the full text of the commitment your booking confirmation page makes about everything that happens next.

"We will be in touch with further information on the event nearer the time — keep an eye out in your inbox."

mdx.ac.uk/about-us/events/undergraduate-open-day/thank-you/

What the page does offer

A virtual tour, a campus film narrated by a student, a link to chat to a current student, and directions. All of it good. All of it offered at the moment of booking, when the day is five weeks away and nobody is planning yet.

What it does not offer

No agenda for their subject. No time to arrive. No calendar file. No note to the person driving them. No named human. Nothing dated to the week it matters.

What we cannot see

The emails that follow. They are sent from inside your systems and are invisible from outside, so we have assumed nothing about them — and we have made them the first thing we ask for on page 25.

Between the booking and the day there is one sentence and a promise. On the evidence available from outside, that is where the attendance goes.

TWO

What a booked person actually meets

The assets exist. They are filed on pages nobody returns to, written in a way that asks the reader to do the remembering, and invisible to the machines that now answer first.

You have already made almost everything a booked person needs.

Every asset below already exists and is already good. The third column is the problem.

The asset	Where it lives	When a booked person would realistically meet it
Full programme with rooms and times	/study/open-days/programme/	Only if they go looking. It is not on the confirmation page.
"What to expect at an open day" film	Embedded on the event page · YouTube	Before booking, if at all. 185 views on YouTube.
Campus tour film narrated by a student	Thank-you page	At the moment of booking, five weeks early.
Live chat with a current student	Unibuddy, linked from the thank-you page	At the moment of booking. Not resurfaced later.
Travel, parking and tube detail	Open days hub, in an accordion	Rarely. It is three clicks from the confirmation.
Subject taster and faculty zone detail	Programme page, lower half	Almost never, and it is the single most persuasive thing on the site.

You have already made the answers. They are filed on pages a booked person visits once, five weeks early, in the ten seconds after they submit a form.

TWO · THE MECHANISM

The current plan asks the applicant to do the remembering.

Two examples read on 12 September, both small, both pointing the same way.

"Subject session times are subject to change, please check back nearer the time."

Open day programme page, live 12 Sep 2026

On 12 September, UK ads carried the line **"Open Days 18 Oct | 21 Nov"**. The hub those ads linked to listed **18 October and 3 November**.

Meta Ad Library, GB, ads live since 24–26 Aug 2026 · mdx.ac.uk/study/open-days, both read 12 Sep 2026

What that sentence delegates

It hands the follow-up to a seventeen-year-old: notice that times may move, remember which page it was on, return to a university website unprompted, and re-read an agenda for an event that is still weeks away. Every one of those steps is a place to lose them, and none of them is their job.

This one may already be fixed

We could not find a 21 November event on the hub, the events listing or the sitemap, and it may simply be a date that moved after the creative was signed off. It may well be corrected by the time you read this — and the instance is not the point. Nothing routinely reconciles live ad creative against what the booking page actually offers, and in a five-week window that reconciliation is precisely the job.

The plan asks a seventeen-year-old to diary a return visit to a university website. They will not, and the calendar invite you did not send is cheaper than the seat you lose.

Your answers are written. The machines that answer first cannot read them.

Presence of event structured data — the markup that lets Google and AI assistants state a date, a place and a booking link with confidence.

Middlesex page	Event markup
/study/open-days/ (where every ad lands)	None
/study/open-days/programme/	None
/about-us/events/undergraduate-open-day/	Event — but malformed
/about-us/events/postgraduate-open-event/	Event — but malformed

What "malformed" means here

The markup gives **location as the words "On campus"** rather than a place with an address, and a relative page URL rather than a full one. Google's event guidance requires a proper address, so as written the event is not eligible for the results it is trying to appear in. This is an afternoon of developer time, not a project.

And the ground is open

We checked the open day landing pages of five universities you compete with directly. None of them carries event markup either:

- Kingston — none
- Greenwich — none
- Hertfordshire — none
- Westminster — none
- Brunel — page markup only

The same is true of your FAQs

Your hub already answers "What happens at a university open day?", "What should I bring?" and "What's the best way to get to campus?" — in good, plain English. None of it is marked up as questions and answers, so an assistant asked those exact questions has no structured Middlesex answer to reach for, and falls back on forums instead.

Your own answers are unreadable to the machines that now answer first — and no competitor has claimed that ground either, which is why it is worth taking this term rather than next.

THREE

The people we have to move

A booking is one name in a form. Attendance is a lift, a Sunday morning, and at least one other person agreeing to spend their weekend on it.

THREE · SEGMENTATION

Three people decide whether one booking becomes one attendance.

Segmented by the part each plays in the decision, not by age or postcode. Only the first of them ever filled in your form.

The applicant who booked

Decides by: imagining themselves there. Booked in a burst of motivation, often weeks out, often for several universities in one sitting.

- **What kills it:** the day becomes abstract. Another university's day feels more real.
- **The job:** make their specific day concrete — their subject, their session, their time.

The person who brings them

Decides by: logistics and worth. A parent, carer or older sibling giving up a Sunday and paying for the fuel or the fares.

- **What kills it:** nobody ever addressed them. They were never sent anything.
- **The job:** give them their own reason to come, and their own thing to do on the day.

The one who went quiet

Decides by: drift. Still interested, no longer sure, has not opened the last two emails and will not open a third that looks the same.

- **What kills it:** a reminder that repeats the booking confirmation.
- **The job:** a different format, a different voice, and an easy way to say "I can't make it, when's the next one".

The detail that makes this concrete: the undergraduate open day is a **Sunday, 9.30am to 3pm**. That is not a diary entry, it is a household negotiation. We could not find a single piece of content on the site or in the live ads that speaks to the second person in that negotiation.

A booking is one name. Attendance is a lift, a Sunday morning and somebody else's agreement — and only one of those three people has ever heard from you.

Most empty seats are not a change of mind.

The reasons a booked seat goes empty, and an honest split of which ones content can move and which ones cannot.

Why they did not come	What it really is	Can content move it?
The day stopped feeling real	Five weeks of silence	Yes — this is the core of the plan
The lift fell through	Nobody ever asked the driver	Yes — speak to the second person
They forgot the time, or the room	No calendar file, no day-before note	Yes — and it is the cheapest fix here
They booked three open days and picked two	A competitive loss, decided in the gap	Partly — whoever feels most concrete wins
They got an offer elsewhere and stopped looking	Out of our hands	No
Illness, work shift, trains, weather	Life	No — but a "catch the next one" route saves the relationship

Most empty seats are not a change of mind. They are a Sunday that got away — and a Sunday can be reclaimed with a message that arrives on the right day.

FOUR

What Middlesex can own

Every university in this set says the same thing about open days. There is one claim none of them makes, and Middlesex already holds the raw material for it.

FOUR · TERRITORY

Everyone promises an experience. Nobody promises a plan.

What the open day category says, who holds each territory, and the row still standing empty.

Territory	Who holds it	What it sounds like
Come and see for yourself	Every university, including Middlesex	"Discover for yourself what it's like to be part of our community."
The rankings proof	Middlesex, heavily	"London's No.1 for Career Prospects." Used in the same words on postgraduate, Clearing, undergraduate and open day ads.
The facilities number	Middlesex and most rivals	"Experience £200m world-class facilities."
The campus film	Everyone	Drone shot, students walking, sunlight.
Knowing exactly how your day will go	Open. Nobody.	"Here is your Sunday: your session, your room, your time, the person you'll meet, and how to get here."

Why this one holds

It cannot be copied quickly, because it is not a line — it is a timetable, a room list and a set of named people, and Middlesex has already published all three. A competitor would have to build the operational detail before they could make the claim. And it is the only territory here that speaks to the second person in the household.

Every university says come and see for yourself. None of them tells you what your Sunday will actually look like.

FOUR · THE IDEA

Your day, before the day.

One organising idea for everything that happens between the booking and the campus gate. Not a slogan for the outside world — a rule for what we send.

What it means for the applicant

Everything they receive is about **their** Sunday, not about Middlesex. Their subject session, at their time, in a named room, with the name of the person running it.

What it means for whoever brings them

They get their own note: where to park, what it costs, what there is to do between 10 and 3, and the two talks worth sitting in on. They arrive with a plan instead of a wait.

What it means for us

Every piece has to pass one test: does this make the day more concrete? A campus beauty shot does not pass. A tube map with a walking time does.

What we would stop sending

- Rankings claims recycled from the Clearing campaign
- "Book now" to somebody who has already booked
- Anything that opens with the word Middlesex
- A second email that looks like the first one

What replaces it

- A one-page personal running order for the day
- A calendar file with the address already in it
- A ninety-second film from the academic they will meet
- A message written to the driver, not the student

Certainty is the only claim in this category still unowned — and Middlesex is one of the few that already has the timetable to back it up.

FIVE

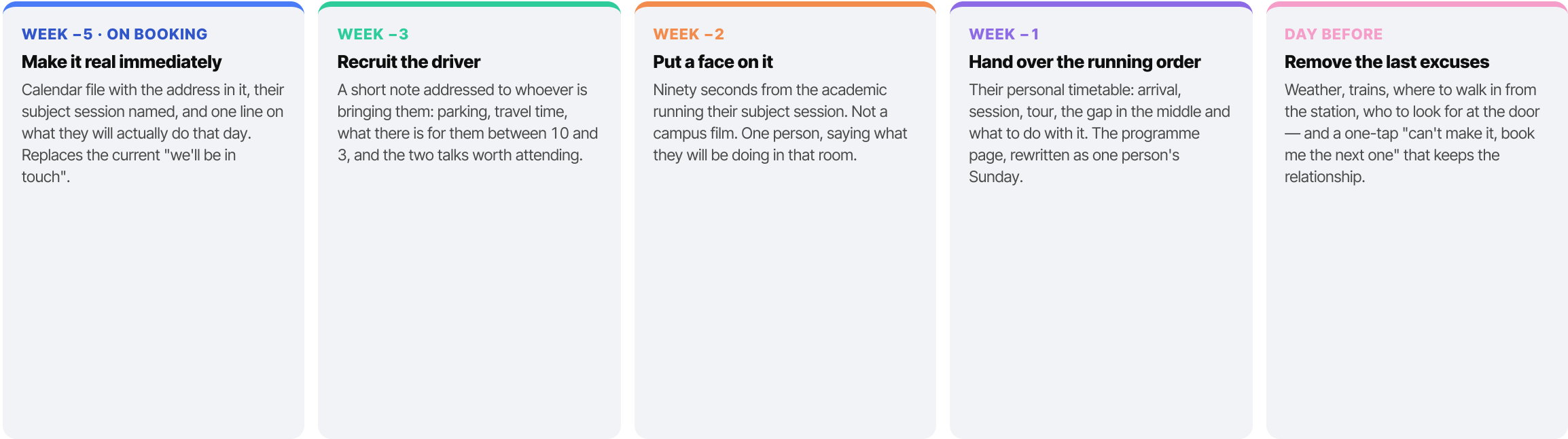
How the plan works

A five-week sequence, a job for the work you have already made, a search and AI fix that takes an afternoon, and a way of measuring it that protects it at month two.

FIVE · THE SYSTEM

Five touches, each answering the question that empties a seat that week.

The window between a typical booking and the undergraduate open day. Each week has one job, one format and one recipient — and no two look alike.



The mistake we avoid

Sending five versions of the same reminder. The reason a person drops out in week three is not the reason they drop out the night before, so the format changes every time — a file, a note to someone else, a video, a timetable, a text. If two touches could be swapped without anyone noticing, one of them is deleted.

Five touches, each answering the one question that empties a seat that week. The week-minus-three note is the one nobody in this category sends.

Our recommendation. The five-week shape is our starting assumption and the first thing your booking data would correct — if most bookings land ten days out, this becomes a three-touch sequence and we would rebuild it that way before spending anything.

The first month is not a production brief.

What we would do with the assets that already exist, before commissioning a single new film.

What you already own	Where it goes	Why
"What to expect" film · 185 views	Week -2 email and the confirmation page	It was made for exactly this moment and has never been placed in it.
Programme page agenda	Rewritten as a one-page personal running order	The content is right; the format asks the reader to do the work.
Student campus tour film	Cut to 45 seconds, sent in week -3	Answers the driver's question, not the student's.
Unibuddy student chat	Resurfaced in week -1, not only at booking	Doubt arrives late. The tool is already paid for.
TikTok reach · 2.51m views	Open day CTA and a link in bio that goes to the hub	The largest audience you gather all year currently asks for nothing.
GeckoEngage booking data	Trigger the sequence off the real booking date	You are already collecting the one signal the whole plan runs on.

The first month is not a production brief. It is putting finished work where it decides something — which is also how we find out what is genuinely missing before you pay to make it.

FIVE · THE DAY, AND THE WEEK AFTER

The people who turn up are the most persuasive content you will ever own.

Six hours on campus, two or three times a year, with several hundred people who chose to be there. Right now that footage is being shot as a campus film.

On the day — capture, don't broadcast

- Three questions, asked on camera at the exit, of people who just spent the day here
- One family filmed arriving and leaving, with their own words on what changed
- Photography shot for next cycle's week –2 email, not for the website carousel

The week after — the handover

- A thank-you that names what they saw, not what Middlesex offers
- One clear next step for people who came and are now deciding
- A different message for the people who booked and did not come, offering the next date

Next cycle — the compound

- Real attendees answering the questions that stop people coming
- Proof that is unfakeable and cannot be bought by a competitor
- A content library that gets cheaper and better every event

A second cycle, proposed separately: turning that footage into a standing answer-engine and search presence — the question pages, the FAQ markup and the video captions that make Middlesex the source an assistant quotes. It is outside this scope and we would quote it on its own once the first cycle has produced the raw material.

The people who turn up are the most persuasive content you will ever own — and they are all in one place, for six hours, three times a year.

Make the event readable by the things that now answer first.

A small, defined workstream that runs alongside the content system and supports your lead generation team rather than competing with it.

1 Fix the event markup

Give both event pages a real address, an absolute URL, a booking link and an attendance mode. This is what makes the open day eligible for event results at all.

2 Put markup where the ads land

The hub takes every click from every open day ad and currently carries no event data at all. It should carry both dates.

3 Mark up the answers you already wrote

"What happens at an open day", "what should I bring", "how do I get there" are already answered well on your hub. Marked up properly, they become quotable by assistants.

4 Clear the stale events

A June 2025 open day page is still live and still submitted for indexing. So is every other page, at top priority — the sitemap marks all 2,584 URLs as equally important, which tells search engines nothing.

Why this matters more this year than last

When a student or a parent asks an assistant "is the Middlesex open day worth going to", it answers from whatever it can read. Today the most readable sources on that question are forum threads. Your own pages answer it better and are not in a form the machine can use.

Honest scope

This is a fix, not a search campaign. It is a specification we write and your web team implements, plus a check that it validates. We are not proposing to take over search, and we would not claim a ranking outcome from it — the measurable result is eligibility and correct rendering, which either happens or does not.

An afternoon of developer time makes the event eligible for results none of your competitors are in. That is the cheapest line in this entire document.

Judge this on show-up rate, or it gets cut in month two.

Three speeds, because the three things this work does become visible at three different times.

What we measure	What it tells us	How soon
Show-up rate by event booked against attended	The only number that says whether this worked. Split by undergraduate, postgraduate and tour.	One event cycle
Sequence engagement by week	Which of the five touches is carrying the result, so we can drop the ones that are not.	Weekly, in cycle
Attendees bringing someone	Whether the week -3 note to the driver is doing its job.	One event cycle
Open day attendee to application	Whether the people we saved were the valuable ones or the casual ones.	One admissions cycle
Event markup validating	Eligibility for event results. Binary, and checkable the day after it ships.	Within days

Why this matters

Judge this work on reach and it looks like a failure next to a TikTok that did 1.2 million views, and the sequence that actually fills seats gets cut. The comparison that matters is your own show-up rate, event against event, against the same period last cycle.

Judge this on show-up rate by event. Judge it on reach and the work that fills the seats is the first thing to go.

FIVE · SCOPE

What sits with us, and what stays with you.

Set out as inclusions and exclusions so there is no argument later about who owns what. Nothing here is costed on purpose — fees and terms follow once the shape below is agreed.

In scope

- The five-week content sequence: concept, copy, art direction and asset production
- Repointing existing assets, including the personal running order format
- The week –3 communication to whoever brings them
- On-the-day capture at the undergraduate and postgraduate events
- Post-event content for attendees and for no-shows
- The search and AI specification, and validation that it shipped correctly
- Show-up reporting against baseline, by event

Not in scope

- **Media buying and paid social.** Your performance team keeps it. We do not touch the buy, the budget or the platforms.
- **Email and CRM build.** We specify and write; your team or your vendor implements in GeckoEngage.
- **Website development.** We write the markup specification; your web team ships it.
- **The open day operation itself** — timetabling, staffing, rooms.
- **Ongoing organic social management.** Proposed separately if you want it.

This sits beside your performance team, not over it. They fill the top of the funnel. We make sure the seats they fill are occupied on the day.

SIX

To start

Five things, each with the reason we want it. Most of this proposal is built on what we could see from outside; these are what would let us replace our assumptions with your facts.

Five things, and what each one would change.

We have deliberately not guessed at any of these, which is why several pages in this document say so explicitly.

- 1 Show-up rate by event, last three cycles**
Why: it is the number this whole engagement is judged on, and we have refused to assume it. It also tells us whether the problem is undergraduate, postgraduate or both.
- 2 The emails a booker currently receives**
Why: your confirmation page promises them and we cannot see them. If a good sequence already exists, half of section five changes from building to sharpening — and we would rather find that out now than in month two.
- 3 The booking curve — when bookings land relative to the event**
Why: the five-week shape is our assumption. If most people book ten days out, the sequence is wrong and we rebuild it before spending anything.
- 4 Confirmed subject session times, earlier than usual**
Why: the personal running order is the centre of the idea, and it cannot be sent if the timetable is still moving. This is an operational ask, not a marketing one.
- 5 Thirty minutes with whoever owns GeckoEngage**
Why: the sequence has to trigger off a real booking date. That conversation decides whether this is straightforward or awkward, and we would rather know before we price the work.

Give us these five and we come back with a calendar built to your real booking curve — not to the one we assumed on page 18.

THE SHIFT

From filling a form to filling a room.

Four things this work does, in the order it does them.

Confirm

Replace "we'll be in touch" with a date, a room and a time they can put in a calendar.

Recruit

Speak to the person giving up their Sunday to drive them, who has never heard from you.

Remind

Five different formats, five different jobs, ending the night before with the last excuses removed.

Compound

Film the people who came, and use them to bring the next ones.

THE BET

Middlesex does not have an attention problem, an open day problem or a media problem.

It has five quiet weeks in the middle of its most valuable funnel — and everything needed to fill them has already been made, and already been paid for.

You are already spending to get the booking. The cheapest place left to grow is making sure the person who booked walks through the door.